

MATCH WORD - Developer Proposal & Milestone Quote

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Spec reference: Match Word Developer Technical Specification, Version 2.0 (June 29, 2026)

Date: June 29, 2026 (Revised — MVP scope agreed at \$6,000 CAD)

Currency: All prices in **CAD**

Engagement type: Fixed-price, milestone-based — payment released only on review and approval

Communication: Freelancer platform chat only

1. Summary

Thank you for sharing the full specification. I have read all 23 sections carefully. Below is my proposed

build plan: a recommended technology stack, a milestone-by-milestone fixed price, an estimated timeline, and the assumptions the quote depends on.

The plan follows your milestone order exactly so each payment maps to a clearly demonstrable deliverable.

Every screen is built to your non-negotiable senior-friendly standards (18pt+ body text, 22pt+ game

actions, 48x48pt tap targets, high contrast, one primary action per screen, no ads, and the word "AI"

never shown anywhere in the app).

Total fixed price: \$6,000 CAD across 9 MVP milestones.

Estimated build duration: ~11–13 working weeks (single developer, sequential milestones).

This revised plan fits the agreed \$6,000 budget by deferring a clear block of retention/polish features to

Phase 2 (built once Match Word is live and subscription revenue is coming in — see Section 4). The full

core game-show experience — characters, lobby, complete gameplay, Guy Smiley host, billing, and store

launch — all remains in the MVP.

2. Recommended Technology Stack

Layer	Recommendation	Why
App framework	Flutter (Dart)	Single codebase for iOS + Android, excellent for image-layered/paper-doll UI, smooth animation, strong on small screens (iPhone SE).
Backend / Realtime	Supabase (Postgres + Realtime + Auth + Storage)	Server-authoritative game state, realtime sync of clues/guesses, secure storage of email + device fingerprints, generous free tier for MVP.
Realtime gameplay	Supabase Realtime channels (WebSocket-based)	Reliable multi-screen sync for clues, guesses, turns, and lobby state.
Voice input	Native iOS <code>SFSpeechRecognizer</code> / Android <code>SpeechRecognizer</code>	No per-use cost, on-device, fast. Text fallback always available per spec §12.
Guy Smiley voice (TTS)	Pre-recorded clips for fixed lines + ElevenLabs for generated lines	Pre-recorded keeps quality high and cost predictable; ElevenLabs used for dynamic announcements. Final approach confirmed with you before §6 work.
Subscriptions	Apple StoreKit 2 (iOS) + Google Play Billing (Android)	Native billing as required; 7-day trial with no card up front.
Auth model	First name + 4-digit PIN, email used only for PIN recovery	Exactly as specified — familiar and simple for seniors.

Note on "no credit card required" trial: the 7-day trial, in-app countdown, and access gating are fully under our control. The store checkout flow itself is controlled by Apple/Google. Configured correctly, the trial starts with no card required; I will confirm the exact store configuration during Milestone 9.

3. Milestone Pricing & Timeline (MVP — \$6,000 CAD)

#	Milestone	Key Deliverables	Est. Days	Price (CAD)
1	Sign In & Account System	First name + 4-digit PIN login, one-time email capture, Forgot-PIN email reset flow, device-ID fingerprint trial-abuse prevention (silent). (<i>IP-based layer</i> → <i>Phase 2.</i>)	5–7	\$550
2	Opening Screen & Navigation	App shell + navigation, Guy Smiley greeting screen, <i>Check Upcoming Games</i> + <i>Enter the Studio</i> buttons, senior-friendly design system (fonts, contrast, tap targets) established here.	4–5	\$400
3	Character Creation System	7-step one-choice-per-screen wizard, paper-doll assembly from client PNG layers, name-on-shirt, preview/confirm, save to profile, edit later.	6–7	\$650
4	Lobby & Game Codes	Create game + 4-digit code, join by code, <i>Check Upcoming Games</i> list, role assignment (Player 1/2/A/B), team formation, AI seat-fill. (<i>Solo stranger matchmaking</i> → <i>Phase 2.</i>)	7–8	\$600
5	Core Gameplay Engine	Server-authoritative turn system, dual input (voice + text) for clues & guesses, clue/guess visible to all, steal mechanic, ~5-exchange word reveal, scoring, first half / halftime / second half, role switch.	12–14	\$1,350
6	Guy Smiley Host + Audio System	Host character with voice + idle animations, rules intro every game, round announcements, theme music + announcer intro, applause/cheer SFX, full disconnect alarm (red flash + ALERT + AWOOGA horn), mute/volume control, silent-mode respect. (<i>MVP uses pre-recorded clips; ElevenLabs dynamic lines</i> → <i>Phase 2.</i>)	8–9	\$750
7	AI Characters	AI clue-giving/guessing logic (moderate difficulty) + a fun starter idle-animation	6–7	\$450

#	Milestone	Key Deliverables	Est. Days	Price (CAD)
		set. (Full animation library + in-game friend-request flow → Phase 2.)		
8	Subscription Billing & Free Trial	\$5.99/mo products on both stores, 7-day no-card trial, Day-3 countdown timer, warm Day-7 prompt, access gating after trial.	7–9	\$800
9	Testing, Bug Fixes & Store Submission	QA pass, senior-usability checks, performance testing on small screens, bug fixes, Apple App Store + Google Play submission support.	6–8	\$450
	TOTAL		~61–74 days	\$6,000

Timeline assumes one milestone at a time, sequential. Days are working days. Calendar duration is longer due to your scheduled-update / weekday / weekends-off working agreement, which I fully respect.

4. What's Included

- Cross-platform iOS + Android app from a single Flutter codebase
- Server-authoritative game logic (game state managed server-side, not client-only)
- Senior-friendly UI standards applied to every screen (\$4 compliance)
- Proof of work (screenshots / test builds) before each milestone payment is released
- Clean, version-controlled (Git) delivery
- Full ownership of all code, assets, and IP transferred to client (\$23)

5. Assumptions & Client-Provided Items

To keep pricing accurate, the quote assumes the **client provides** the following (as stated in the spec):

- **All character art** as layered PNG files (bases, hair, eyes, glasses, outfits) — §8
- **AI idle animation assets** — the starter set for MVP, full library in Phase 2 — §11
- **Guy Smiley character art** and any reference avatars — §5
- **Brand assets and colours** (#5B2D8E etc.) — §5
- **Trophy and prize art** in clay style — §18 (Phase 2)

The developer will **source licensed theme music + announcer audio** (warm, classic game-show style) as part of the MVP — §16. The developer builds the assembly, rendering, logic, and integration systems around the client-provided assets.

The developer builds the assembly, rendering, logic, and integration systems around these assets.

6. Phase 2 — Deferred Features (built once subscription revenue begins)

To fit the agreed **\$6,000 CAD** budget, the following features are deferred to Phase 2. None of them are part of the core game-show loop — they are retention and polish features that make the most sense to add once players are subscribing. Each can be quoted as its own milestone when you're ready.

Deferred feature	Spec ref	Indicative Phase 2 price (CAD)
Prize Room & Trophy System (display room, earning logic, expansion)	§18	~\$550
Solo stranger matchmaking + in-game friend-making	§9, §17	~\$450
Full AI idle-animation library (MVP ships a fun starter set)	§11	~\$400
ElevenLabs dynamic Guy Smiley announcements (MVP uses warm pre-recorded clips)	§14	~\$300

Deferred feature	Spec ref	Indicative Phase 2 price (CAD)
IP-based trial-abuse layer (MVP uses device-ID fingerprinting)	§6	~\$150
Physical mailed trophies (already Phase 2 in your spec)	§18	TBD

The MVP still delivers the complete experience players see and feel: characters, studio, teams, clues, guesses, steals, scoring, Guy Smiley host with voice, the disconnect alarm, billing, and store launch.

7. Out of Scope (not planned)

- Tournament bracket system (beyond basic trophy milestone)
- Advanced AI behaviour beyond "moderate difficulty" baseline
- Backend infrastructure costs (Supabase paid tier, ElevenLabs usage, Apple/Google developer accounts) — these are operating costs billed to the client's own accounts, not developer fees
- Localization / multi-language support

8. Payment & Working Terms

- Fixed price per milestone, agreed before that milestone begins
 - No full payment up front; each milestone is funded, then built, then reviewed, then released
 - Proof of work provided before each release
 - Any scope change agreed in writing before work begins (§23)
 - All communication on Freelancer platform chat only; questions grouped into scheduled updates; weekends respected
 - Prices quoted in **CAD** to match your Freelancer budget
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9. Starting Point

We begin with **Milestone 1 (Sign In & Account System)** as agreed. The senior-friendly design system (fonts, contrast, tap targets) is established in Milestone 2 so you can approve the visual direction early.

10. Confirmed Decisions

1. **Tech stack** — **Flutter + Supabase** (confirmed; client already uses Supabase elsewhere).
 2. **Guy Smiley voice** — Mix of **pre-recorded clips + ElevenLabs** for dynamic lines (ElevenLabs dynamic layer scheduled for Phase 2).
 3. **Audio assets** — Developer to **source licensed audio** for theme music + announcer (warm, fun, classic game-show style).
 4. **Asset delivery** — Client is preparing character art now; ready before the dependent milestones (3, 6, 7).
 5. **Starting milestone** — **Milestone 1** confirmed.
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Honesty note (per spec §2): I have flagged the Apple/Google trial-checkout nuance and the dependency on client-provided art/audio assets up front. I am confident in delivering every component to the standard described. If any asset or scope detail shifts during the build, I will raise it immediately rather than absorb it silently.